



HIREVUE'S AI-POWERED ASSESSMENTS

AI IN HR



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Executive Summary



SYSTEM:

Hirevue conducts pre-recorded, on-demand, AI-powered interview assessments to help companies screen out applicants. Candidates are invited to complete a Hirevue interview, in which they can complete the call whenever and answer a series of pre-determined questions set by the company. The applicant is then reviewed by AI, producing an assessment score, similar to the ones in the next slide. From there, the company's HR team is said to review these interviews to determine who proceeds to the next round. Hirevue is meant to replace the resume review or phone screening portion of the process, but ultimately, humans make the final hiring decision.

MAIN ETHICAL CONCERNS:

- **Algorithmic Bias**
 - Training Data = Historical Data → Continuing Bias
- **Black Box Model**
 - True transformation of input into output is hidden
- **Privacy & Data Security**
 - Sensitive biometric data being retained

RECOMMENDATIONS:

- 1) Minimize collection of biometric data with automatic detection
- 2) True informed consent process with opt-out options
- 3) Mandate human oversight at all steps and in final decision
- 4) Establish historical bias audits and diverse data requirements
- 5) Require Hirevue to provide algorithmic transparency

CONCLUSION:

While Hirevue offers clear value in an overwhelmed job market, its effectiveness depends on trustworthy auditing and responsible AI policies, which currently face political uncertainty. Ultimately, HR must ensure any AI system aligns with organizational values by upholding fairness, transparency, and accountability to protect all stakeholders.

Company Overview



hirevue

Legal Structure:

Private Company
owned by The
Carlyle Group

Company Name:

Hirevue, Inc.

Year Founded:

2004

CEO:

Jeremy Friedman,
former founder of
Schoolology

Services:

- Video Interviewing
- Assessments
- Scheduling
- AI and text-based recruiting services

Team Size:

201-500
Employees

HEART OF VALUES

- Hero for our customers
- Enjoy the journey
- Always do the right thing
- Reach forward
- Take action and go

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

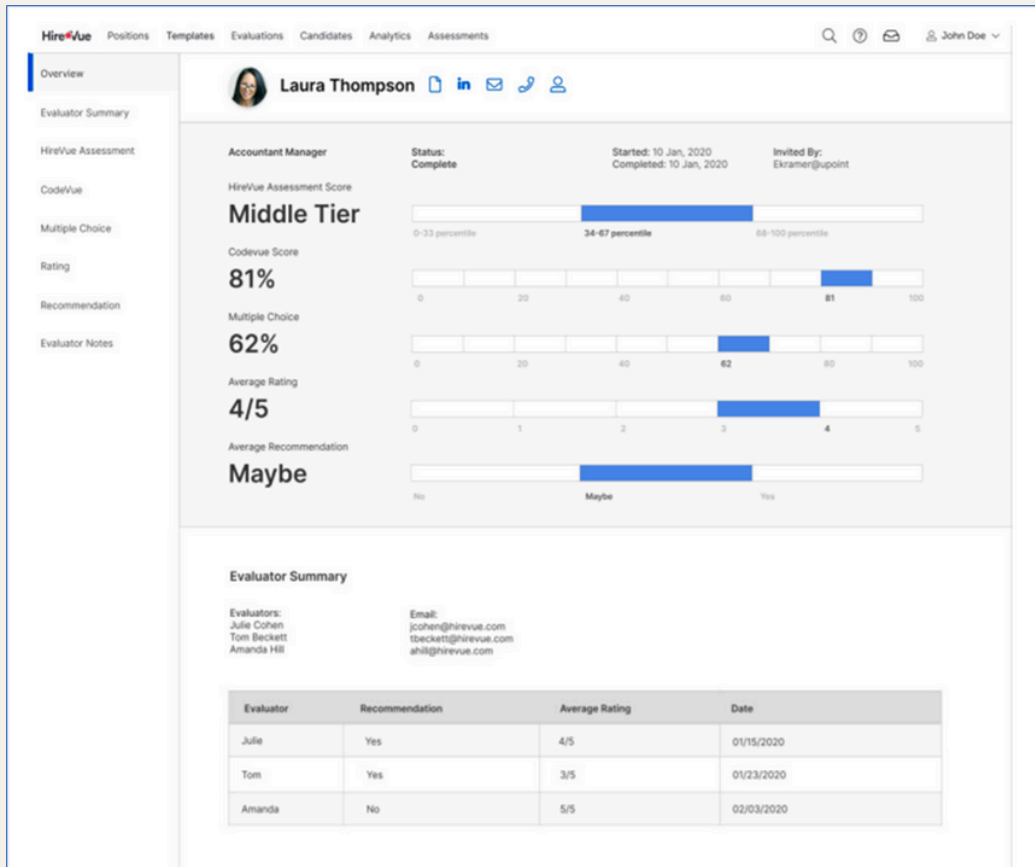


Hirevue's AI system **takes in four main data types**: video and audio from interviews and games, textual data from resumes and answers to text-based questions, behavioral data from real-time decision-making and problem-solving behavior, and training data from historical data. To get the data, Hirevue takes direct inputs from candidates, third-party data providers, and historical employment data with characteristics of successful and unsuccessful employees.

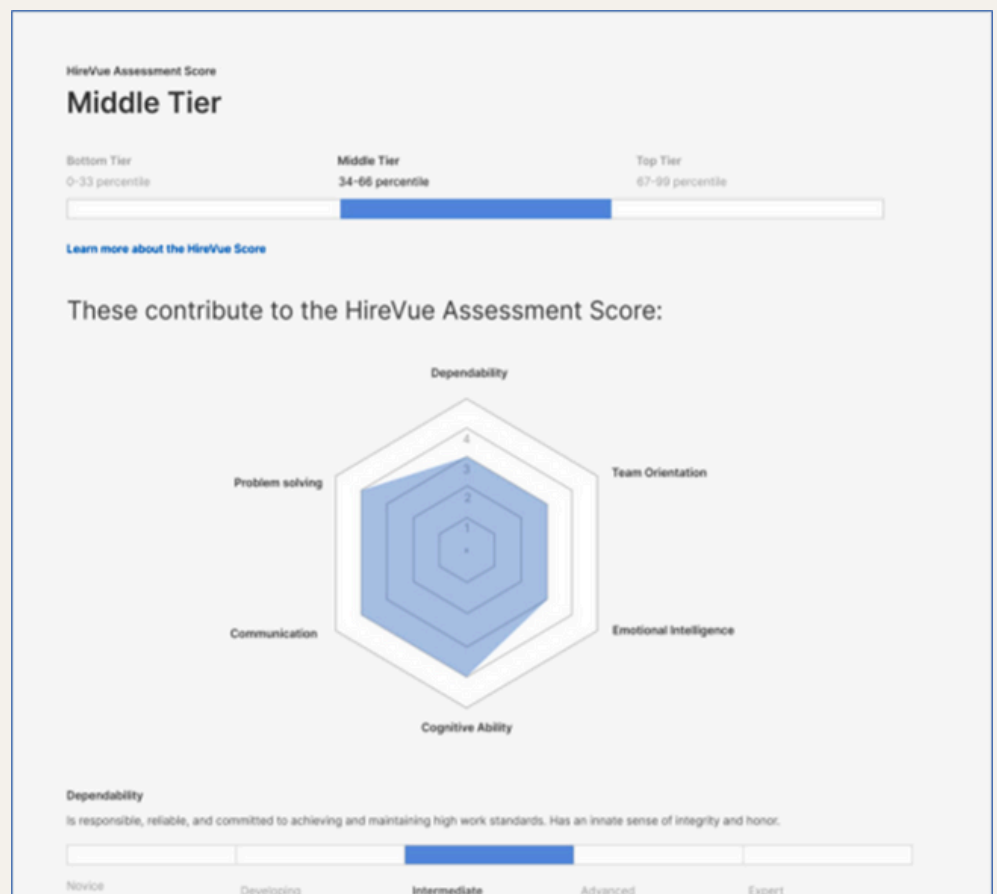
Hirevue states that their **algorithm** grades based on skills, behaviors, and competencies related to the job as set by HR, rather than cues like attire or resume keywords. The algorithm compares candidates' assessments to the training data of successful and unsuccessful employees to produce an **assessment score**, as seen in the next slide. Hirevue has since stated they are moving **away from facial recognition** grading to only scoring transcripts, even eliminating variations in tone or pauses. However, it is still considered to have a **black box algorithm**, which will be later explored. In short, the true workings of the system are not known to any stakeholders.

Many **notable companies** use this system, including Humana, Oracle, Hilton, Amazon, JPMorgan Chase, Apple, Deloitte, and many more. Its **main purpose** is to speed up the hiring process through on-demand interviews and assessments. It can be **seen in** early round interviews for behavioral questions through interviews or in late round stages of interviews where technical skills are being tested through the technical assessments.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW



Example Assessment Reports



ETHICAL ANALYSIS

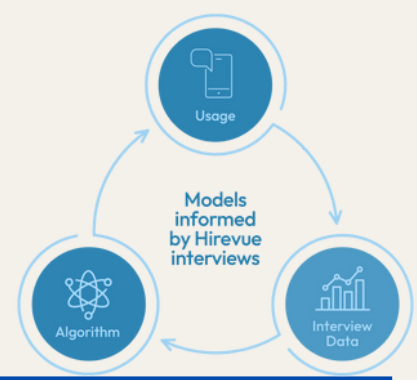


This section dives into **three ethical concerns** that users have faced when using Hirevue. In each concern, the views of the stakeholders of **candidates** and the **company** will be compared to include multiple perspectives in this assessment. **Hirevue's responses** to these concerns are also explored.





ALGORITHMIC BIAS



Hirevue's algorithm is trained on **historical data**, in which the algorithm is fed past data and learns successful and unsuccessful traits to then apply to candidates and produce an assessment score. However, this system can be extremely flawed. If historical data reflects human bias, the **system will repeat that bias**. This contradicts how Hirevue aims to remove human bias through consistent interview procedures and grading. **Amazon** faced this issue: their algorithm had penalized females as most of their training data consisted of men.

Candidates

Candidates in **underrepresented demographics** are left at a **disadvantage**, automatically denied due to the AI's grading. The **ACLU** filed charges against Intuit and Hirevue, claiming the **speech recognition system failed** to "accurately recognize and analyze the speech of a **deaf applicant**," resulting in a lower score. Portions of the interview process also lacked subtitles. Many candidates are even **discouraged** from continuing in the hiring process at all if Hirevue is used, as they **do not trust** the scoring system used.

Companies

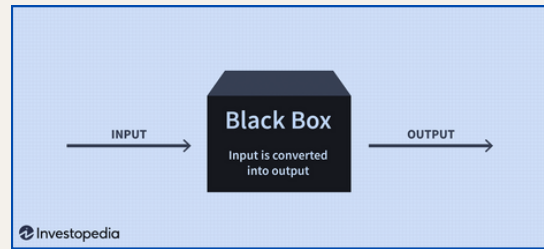
Companies are left at a disadvantage if there is algorithmic bias because **qualified candidates** are getting **turned away** for seemingly 'undesired' traits that were not even set by the company. To prevent AI overreliance, companies maintain **human oversight** over the system. For instance, while Humana utilized Hirevue for initial screenings, candidate videos were still reviewed to determine who progressed.

Hirevue

Hirevue has a dedicated portion on their page to answer how they work to prevent bias. They don't deny that training data can lead to algorithmic bias. To counter historical bias, **rigorous testing and audits** are conducted to mitigate bias. Through work with their industrial-organizational (I/O) psychologists, they use decades of work on **pre-hire assessments** to prevent bias. In their **AI Explainability statement**, this is further explored. Data scientists and I/O psychologists work together to **remove data that leads to discrimination**, while ensuring there is enough to maintain an accurate system. This results in a bias-mitigated assessment that enhances decision-making and **promotes diversity and equal opportunity for all**. The system trained then remains **static** and **deterministic**, meaning the algorithms don't learn on the fly and produce repeatable output when used. The system can only learn if it is set to learn.



THE BLACK BOX



The image above portrays a '**Black Box Model**,' where the algorithm takes in input to generate outputs, **without revealing how** that transformation occurs. Hirevue operates in a similar way. Although its product documentation is extensive, it offers **little clarity** on how the algorithm actually evaluates and scores candidates. Users are told what the system is trained on and what it measures, but not how these factors are weighted, creating fairness and transparency concerns.

Candidates

Candidates understand that their actions and words are being taken into the system but **are not fully aware of how they are being graded**. Daniel Johnson perfectly puts it: "You're assessed by unseen metrics, against undefined standards, with no opportunity to ask for clarification or feedback." Candidates **do not receive any feedback** on their performance, only whether they are moving forward in the process. This leaves a lack of **explainability** which is a key ethical principle. Candidates do not get to learn from their mistakes and do not see the criteria that guided this decision.

Companies

Even with no clear answer as to **how** the system works, companies trust its **effectiveness** and **efficiency** and use it **alongside human review**. The system helps rank candidates so that interviewers can spend time **reviewing just the top interviews** rather than all interviews. HR gets to see how the candidates rank against skills crucial for the role being interviewed for. This saves a company **time** and **money**, allowing them to view interviews on their own time, rather than have scheduled ones for (typically) initial rounds of screening. However, there are still companies wary of the system due to the failures seen in other companies, such as the Intuit case discussed earlier.

Hirevue

Hirevue calls this a 'myth' and debunks it. They describe how there is an entire field dedicated to AI explainability and do **list specific tools** used, like Large Language Models, and **teams involved**, like IO psychologists and data scientists. They state that for competitive purposes, they cannot reveal their entire algorithm as it is **intellectual property** and would make them vulnerable to competition. In 2022, Hirevue released an **AI Explainability Statement** – the first in the HR industry. It has since been updated in 2024 and provides a clear explanation of how they designed their AI, which was by using their CUSTARD NLP model.



PRIVACY & DATA SECURITY



Hirevue collects **sensitive data**, including video recordings, voice data, facial cues, and environmental indicators. This then raises ethical concerns about how long this data is stored, who has access to it, whether it will be used for purposes other than hiring, whether candidates truly give **informed consent**, and the risk of data breaches when dealing with biometric information. This ethical concern is increased tenfold as the current administration is **shifting priority from responsible AI to rapidly-produced AI**. The National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) was instructed to **eliminate references to AI safety, responsibility, and fairness**. As Daniel Johnson puts it, “speed wins. Even if people lose.”

Candidates

Hirevue offers **informed consent** with a detailed welcome screen that explains what the online interview will entail, whether AI or humans will be reviewing the responses, and how the hiring team will use this recorded video in their final decision. However, even with this informed consent, there is the **added pressure** and need to not fall behind in the competitive hiring environment. Thus, candidates feel as though they have **no choice** but to consent to this system. They then **worry** about how long their data is stored, who has access, and whether it could be used beyond hiring. In 2022, a **class action lawsuit** was filed because biometric data was allegedly being collected without informed consent, violating the Illinois Biometric Information Privacy Act (BIPA).

Companies

Companies find Hirevue to be **efficient** in conducting interviews and **rely** on it to **store that data**. A **breach** to Hirevue impacts **company reputation** and leaves them **liable** to any information leaked, so when companies use Hirevue, they place immense trust in their system and methods. Hirevue’s use of **third-party certifications, independent audits, and data encryption** prove to be extremely secure. The extreme **documentation** shows that Hirevue cares about being fair, reliable, and safe, for all stakeholders.

Hirevue

Hirevue addresses their **commitment** to protecting the **integrity** and **privacy** of candidate information on their website. Firstly, they state they are the only video interviewing vendor that is third-party certified for both application and data storage. They then use **role-based permissions**, so only the ones who need to see the data can view it. They also follow **industry standards** like ISO/IEC 27001:2022 & ISO/IEC 27701:2019, SOC 2 Type 2, and FedRAMP, through third-party audits. **More compliance guidelines** are shown in the top left. Hirevue’s **Privacy Notice** goes more in depth on the collection, use, and disclosure of information.

Personal Information Collected



In [Hirevue's Privacy Notice](#), they describe how they collect, use, and protect personal information from users visiting their website. Below will be details on the **collection** of information.

INFORMATION YOU PROVIDE:

- **IDENTITY DATA**

Such as name, organization name, email address, postal address, and phone number

- **DEMOGRAPHIC DATA**

Such as age, gender, job level, and functional role

- **PAYMENT DATA**

Such as card numbers, financial account information, and other payment details

- **COMMUNICATIONS AND RECORDING DATA**

Such as communication type, content, subject, sender, recipient, and data; recorded calls, online meetings, email, chat, or other communications payment details

- **CONTENT AND FILES**

Such as photos, documents, feedback, or other files

- **PREFERENCE DATA**

Such as language or display settings, frequency and format

INFORMATION AUTOMATICALLY COLLECTED:

- **DEVICE DATA**

IP address, browser type, internet service provider, resources viewed, operating system

- **DEVICE DATA**

Country or city level location

- **USAGE DATA**

URL of website redirected from, pages viewed, time spent on a page, access times

- **INFORMATION WE CREATE**

Infer new information based on preferences and characteristics

Personal Information Collected



Below are the details on the **use** and **disclosure** of information.

USE OF INFORMATION:

- **TO PROVIDE THE SERVICES AND FEATURES YOU WISH TO ACCESS**

Operate, maintain, enhance, support, troubleshoot, and provide

- **TO CONDUCT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT**

Interactions with product demos, industry white papers, and research papers

- **TO DELIVER ADVERTISING AND SEND MARKETING**

Send marketing (news, promotions, offers, surveys) and advertise with requested preferences

- **TO MANAGE RELATIONSHIPS AND BUSINESS OPERATIONS**

Billing, accounting, and improving internal operations

- **TO GENERATE ANALYTICS**

Better understand visitor and customer usage

- **TO COMMUNICATE WITH YOU**

*Communicate for inquiries, including via email, phone, video, or online chat
Sales phone calls and online meetings may be recorded for training, quality assurance, and administration purposes*

- **TO MAINTAIN SECURITY**

Detect and prevent fraudulent behavior or violation of terms of service

- **TO COMPLY WITH LEGAL REQUIREMENTS**

Laws and regulations (legal requirements to report tax, disclose information to law enforcement, etc.)

DISCLOSURE OF INFORMATION:

- **TO OUR GROUP COMPANIES**

Disclose personal information with other Hirevue group companies where necessary for reasons above

- **TO COMPETENT AUTHORITIES**

To exercise, establish, or defend legal claims, protect vital interests or person, or comply with requests from courts

- **TO ADVERTISING PROVIDERS**

Cookie IDs, device IDs, IP address, geolocation data, usage data, and inferences based on that data

- **TO OUR SERVICE PROVIDERS**

Hosting, marketing and analytics, financial services, communication, and IT providers

- **TO PARTIES IN A CORPORATE TRANSACTION OR PROCEEDING**

To parties involved in corporate transaction or proceedings, like merger, financing, acquisition, etc.

- **TO ANY OTHER THIRD PARTY**

Only with consent or when permitted by law

ETHICAL PERSPECTIVES



Deontological

Deontological ethics would criticize the **lack of respect for human dignity**. A **system for efficient hiring is prioritized** over a fair, transparent, and *human* evaluation process. Furthermore, the use of historical data as training data leaves room for human bias to repeat. The 'black box' algorithm also leaves a lack of **transparency** and **explainability** where users are unaware of how exactly they are being graded. The interview process, and thus system, has a **duty of non-deception**, which Hirevue works to do by continuing to provide more consent information without revealing intellectual property. Lastly, there is a **duty to treat all applicants equally with an accommodating system**. The system has proven to fail to meet this, like with the Intuit case.

Teleological

Teleological ethics would find that this system **enhances efficiency** in the hiring process for companies. Both companies and candidates are given **greater flexibility**: candidates can complete the interview whenever in the given timespan and companies can review the videos on their own time. **The results do align with the intended end**: the hiring process is more efficient. A company can now **handle hundreds of applicants** as Hirevue filters out ones not suited for the job's description and company's culture. HR can then **focus their attention** towards the top performing candidates. There is also the **intended outcome of reduced bias** through consistent scoring. With solely human interviews, emotions can influence. However, the system is meant to create a **repeated process** and system for each candidate.

Recruiter: faster time to hire, reduce bias, efficient scheduling

Candidate: flexible, convenient, streamlined, practice responses

Virtue Ethics

Virtue ethics would call for a system that is **fair, transparent, and just**. Hirevue is more difficult to analyze in this perspective as there are many pros and cons. Starting with the cons, the **system lacks empathy**. In interviews, you are told to showcase your personality and emphasize how you fit the culture. However, candidates have expressed how talking to a screen really felt draining and dystopian. Furthermore, the system can be seen as **unjust** as it uses historical data that can perpetuate human biases. Lastly, the system is rather **opaque** as candidates view the algorithm as a black box. On the other hand, the pros of this system are it creates consistency with the same questions and process given to every candidate and the same objective metrics used to rate candidates. This creates a **fair system** that eliminates human assumptions in early rounds. Although the system is seen as a black box, Hirevue **aims to be transparent and create an explainable system** through its AI explainability statements.



RECOMMENDATIONS

Minimize Collection of Biometric Data with Automatic Deletion

To address the concerns pertaining to the collection, storage, and use of candidates' personal data, the organization would need to adopt practices that **limit the amount of candidate data** stored, explain how it is stored, and share how long it is stored. The **Chief Technology Officer** would need to ensure that **data collected not related** to the job are **removed** from the database. **All biometric data** should also be **deleted** within two weeks of the final hiring decision, potentially with encrypted backups. The **legal** and **IT teams** would need to demonstrate how compliance is being followed with **thorough and public audit documentation**. This is extremely important, especially as the current administration lessened safeguards on AI safety and responsible use.

True Informed Consent Process with Opt-Out Options

The HR and legal teams would work together to redesign the candidate consent process to ensure **true informed consent**. Although Hirevue does reveal how its algorithms worked and what data is being collected, it fails to do so in a simple manner. Instead, candidates should be provided with a **plain-language explanation** of exactly **what data is collected, how facial cues and environmental indicators are taken into consideration, and strides the company takes to mitigate harm from data breaches**. Candidates should also be given the option to opt-out of this style and participate in video interviews without facial analysis or complete a structured phone interview. Many companies do provide a separate system to request accommodations, so this is extremely crucial. The Talent Acquisition Leads in HR should be trained on teaching hiring managers how to be accommodating without penalizing candidates opting out of biometric collection.

Mandate Human Oversight at All Steps and in Final Decision

Given the risks of black box decision-making, biometric data vulnerabilities, and the use of historical data as training data - which are all then worsened by the administration's failure to create AI safeguards to protect our usage - the HR team must ensure AI is **never the final decision-maker**. Instead, this should be done by a human. Hirevue's own website states that the algorithms are meant to **enhance human decision-making**, not replace. However, companies can still choose to solely rely on the AI. In an ideal world, all interviews would be reviewed by humans, even if the AI gave a low scoring. However, in a world where hiring managers are facing immense volumes of applications and increasing turnovers, Hirevue creates an efficient method of speeding up the hiring process. Whenever **bias is suspected**, such as the algorithm consistently scoring high on professional backgrounds but low on informal ones, **HR** is responsible for **overriding decisions** and **reporting** these algorithmic errors to the **data science team**. **Rejections** based on Hirevue scores should still receive **some form of human review** with **documented justification** on why the candidate did not proceed, rather than failing solely due to an unknown algorithm. In all cases, recipients should be receiving feedback of their scores to improve the lack of transparency the system has.



RECOMMENDATIONS

Establish Historical Bias Audits and Diverse Data Requirements

Since Hirevue's reliance on historical hiring data as training data will repeat past discrimination (as demonstrated by Amazon's gender-biased algorithm), the **HR analytics team** should conduct **quarterly historical bias audits** to determine whether past 'successful' employees heavily center around a certain demographic. If the training data finds that a large majority of new hires from this system are male, white, or from certain schools, the algorithm is in dire need of bias-mitigation strategies like **fairness constraints** that prevent the model from learning demographics, and instead solely focus on traits and skills. The **Chief Diversity Officer** should be working with the **data science team** to **create diverse data**, even if it is synthetic, through strategies like **data augmentation** or **resampling**, to balance out the datasets. This all relies on **human oversight** where humans need to be aware of how the algorithm works, consistently review data, and ensure that clear metrics for fairness are being used.

Require Hirevue to Provide Algorithmic Transparency

Hirevue should be working with their customers to create a **system of mutual trust**. The **Chief Technology Officer** and **legal team** would work together to create **obligations that Hirevue must meet** before the system can be implemented in this company. This can include how various factors are weighted (environmental, facial, speech), the decision logic in ranking candidates, and a clear explanation of how traits are examined through a supposed 'solely-transcript based' algorithm. In summary, a **clear guide** of how the candidate's **inputs become** the provided **output** should be provided for **explainability**. It is understood that there is a level of secrecy due to intellectual privacy and fear of competition. However, when dealing with such sensitive data, the system cannot be fully hidden, especially when this company will be relying on Hirevue to protect their potential employees' data. Hirevue does enable companies to tailor interviews to specific job fits, so some characteristics are able to be weighed more heavily, but it is still a matter of **how** are these characteristics evaluated. The **team responsible for vendor management** should require Hirevue to provide **quarterly reports on algorithm performance**, including changes they have made to reduce potential bias. If Hirevue fails to meet these obligations and transparency standards are not met, the company should be able to terminate the use of Hirevue.

CONCLUSION



In conclusion, this assessment explored **Hirevue**, an AI-powered assessment platform used by HR to conduct and analyze video interviews and skill-based assessments. While Hirevue maintains extensive documentation that makes companies trust its use and allow it to replace rounds of screening, candidates are extremely skeptical of the system, claiming there is no transparent breakdown of how non-verbal cues are weighted.

However, Hirevue is extremely promising. Aside from making the initial screening rounds less human, in a world where 200+ applications are expected prior to an offer, **Hirevue is a means to meet demand** in the troubling job market where HR is already overwhelmed with tasks and applicants. The **main ethical concerns** were pertaining to algorithmic bias, the black box model, and privacy and data security. To address these concerns, the **recommendations** are to minimize collection of biometric data with automatic deletion, provide true informed consent process with opt-out options, mandate human oversight at all steps with the final decision made by humans, establish historical bias audits and diverse data requirements, and require Hirevue to provide algorithmic transparency prior working with this company. From an efficiency standpoint, Hirevue can add great value to the company. With the added recommendations, it would serve as a well-rounded system that improves efficiency that still maintains human-ness in the interview process.

For the path forward, it is important to note that Hirevue uses firms like the DCI Consulting Group, ORCAA, and Landers Workforce Science LLC, to review audits of this system. How sure are we that these companies are without bias? Furthermore, the Trump administration continues to remove responsible AI and fairness policy to instead expand America's global AI position and rapidly produce AI. There have been instances where Hirevue fails to accommodate for marginalized applicants. Daniel Johnson wisely puts this: "Efficiency at scale sounds great - until you've realized you've scaled dehumanization."

HR handles high-impact decisions with hiring, promotions, and performance evaluations. Maintaining ethical AI is crucial to **ensure fairness, transparency, and accountability**. Without safeguards to reduce bias, AI systems can create discriminatory results that lead to legal, financial, and reputational risks. **It is our responsibility to ensure the AI systems we are using uphold organizational values, especially in an era where regulatory safeguards are being destroyed.** We must hold ourselves accountable to ethical standards to protect all stakeholders.

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